

For Masters, World Championships Seniors and Olympic Games, the contest area shall be 10 m x 10 m with a minimum common safety area of 4 m and a minimum exterior safety area of 4 m. This size is also recommended for Continental Championships.

Any decoration on the tatami, such as the host city name, year or event logos, can only be placed on the safety area, never on the contest area. This decoration should not be slippery.

A certified Video Replay System is mandatory for all IJF-sanctioned competitions. The system must be the official IJF Video Replay System or an alternative expressly approved by the IJF. It shall be available for all competition areas, operated by trained personnel, and integrated with the official timing and scoring system. The purpose of the system is to ensure fairness, accuracy, and athlete safety by enabling the review of critical moments from multiple angles and speeds. The system's output must be provided to the venue's main video display(s) and to the host broadcaster for inclusion in television and streaming coverage, and shall be displayed in selected cases such as official reviews, confirmed scores, or educational sequences as determined by the IJF Referee Commission.

The LOC must give the IJF all audio-embedded TV feeds for the **Computer Assisted Replay (CARE)** system, live streaming and TV archives. Refer to the EOG for further information.

For each competition area there must be two (2) scoreboards that indicate the scores horizontally, placed outside the competition area where they can be easily seen by the athletes, referees, commission members, officials, and spectators.

Manual scoreboards, manual timers, bell or similar audio device and flags (yellow and green) must be available as backup.

When using several competition areas at the same time - the use of different audible signals is required. The time signal must be loud enough to be heard over the noise of the spectators.

The LOC must have a set of reserve radios in case there are any issues with the IJF ones.

For certain events e.g., Olympic Games the tatami may be placed on a solid platform. The platform must be made of wood or a similar material. It must be one metre wider and longer than the tatami dimensions. The height will depend on the sightlines in the sport hall. When using a platform, the exterior tatami safety area must be a minimum of 4 m. If the tatami needs to have microphones installed between them then this should be done by contractors.

8.8 Medical

All medical matters are the responsibility of the IJF Medical Commission. Refer to the IJF Medical Handbook in Appendix E.

A1.8 Draw for Veterans

The draw for the individual weight categories will take place at 19.00 hours on the day before the competition. Information on the exact location of the individual weight category draws will be displayed on the event official notice board.

A complete list of athletes who have successfully fulfilled the weight requirements will be displayed outside the room where the official draw will take place a minimum of 15 minutes prior to the draw starting.

Team officials from each country (or individual athletes) must check this list to ensure that all their athletes are on the list in the correct age division and weight category. The IJF Veterans Commission take no responsibility for someone who is not included in the draw because they were missing from the list, and no one from the delegation checked.

A1.9 Seeding for Veterans

In the veterans' event, there is no seeding.

A1.10 Weigh-in for Veterans

The weigh-in will take place the day before the competition as indicated in the outlines. There is no random weigh-in for veterans.

A1.11 Judogi Rules for Veterans

All athletes **MUST** compete wearing a white or blue IJF approved judogi and belt (see IJF website for the list of suppliers). The judogi and belt must conform to the rules in Appendix C.

A1.12 Backnumbers for Veterans

The backnumber must conform to the rules in Appendix C.

A1.13 Competition System for Veterans

The type of competitions system to be applied in the competition will depend on the number of entries as follows:

Competition systems according to number of participants:

- 6 and more entries: double repechage
- 3, 4, 5 entries: round robin
- 2 entries: best of 2 contests, if 1-1 the third contest will decide.

In case the number of participants in a category is not sufficient, (age and/or weight) categories will be combine according to IJF SOR. All the contests in any one age division will be held on the same day.

The IJF do not have team events for veterans. If other organisations choose to hold team events the rules should be clearly defined in the event outlines.

A1.14 Round Robin Golden Score

If a round robin contest goes into golden score, an athlete can hold osaekomi-waza until for ippon.



Hajime! and Sore-made!



Ippon (100 points marked as ippon on the scoreboard): the referee raises one arm high above the head with the palm of the hand facing forward.



Waza-ari (10 points on the scoreboard): the referee raises one arm sideways to shoulder height with the palm of the hand facing downwards.

The waza-ari gesture:

- Should start with the arm across the chest, then sideways to the correct finishing position.

However, care should be taken when turning to keep the athletes within view.



Waza-ari-awasete-ippon (two waza-ari score ippon, 100 points, marked as ippon on the scoreboard): first waza-ari, then the ippon gesture.



Yuko (1 point on the scoreboard): the referee raises one arm sideways with the palm of the hand facing downwards, 45 degrees from his body.

The yuko gesture:

- Should start with the arm across the chest, then sideways to the correct finishing position.



Osaekomi! (Hold is on!): while bending his body towards the athletes, shall point his arm, with the palm of the hand facing downwards. The referee must check that the timekeeper has started the timer before stopping the gesture and returning to a normal position to control the contest.

b) When both athletes have no technical score, or the technical scores are equal at the end of the regular contest time, the contest shall continue in golden score regardless of the number of shido given.

c) In the case where both athletes have no score or both have yuko or waza-ari or equal scores of both yuko and waza-ari and then score ippon simultaneously during the time allotted for regular time, the contest shall be decided by a "golden score" period.

d) In the case where one athlete has waza-ari and then both score ippon simultaneously during the time allotted for regular time, the contest shall be allowed to continue until the end.

4. Golden score period

In individual and team competitions when contest time ends with the circumstances of paragraph 3b. of this article, the referee shall announce "Sore-made!" to end the contest temporarily and the athletes shall return to their starting positions.

The referee shall announce "Hajime!" to restart the contest once the scoreboard is ready. There shall be no rest period between the end of the original contest and the start of golden score.

There is no time limit for golden score. Any existing score(s) and/or numbers of shido from regular time are carried into the golden score period and will remain on the score board.

Golden score can be won by a technical score (yuko, waza-ari or ippon), hansoku-make (direct or by accumulative shido) or kiken-gachi. If a direct hansoku-make is given, the consequences are the same as those in regular time.

The referee will then announce "Sore-made!".

Special situations during golden score.

a) Should only one athlete exercise his right to participate in the "golden score" period, and the other athlete declines, the athlete who wishes to compete shall be declared the winner by "kiken-gachi".

b) In the case where both athletes score ippon, waza-ari or yuko simultaneously the referee shall announce "Mate!", continuing the contest without considering these actions for scoring purposes.

c) For direct hansoku-make given to both athletes, the IJF Ad Hoc Commission will decide.

d) "Osaekomi!" starting in golden score

If "Osaekomi!" starts in golden score, after 5 seconds of osaekomi, tori will be awarded yuko, and the contest will end. The referee shall announce "Yuko! Sore-made!".

5. CARE system

The IJF Head Referee Director(s) and IJF Referee Supervisor(s) are responsible for all rules and decisions during the contest.

IJF Referee Supervisor(s) with the collaboration of the IJF Head Referee Director(s) must intervene in any circumstance in which an evaluation or a procedure made by the referee is not in harmony with the IJF refereeing rules.

This decision is taken for the safety of the athletes, so they do not try to escape from the technique and endanger their cervical spine.

No score or penalty will be given if the landing of uke occurs on the body of tori, in such a way that not all parts of uke's body involving the bridge situation (head, foot or feet) touch the tatami.

Ippon evaluation in ne-waza

a) When an athlete holds with osaekomi-waza the other athlete, who is unable to get away for 20 seconds after the announcement of "Osaekomi!".

b) When an athlete gives up by tapping twice (2) or more with his hand or foot or says "Maitta!" (I give up!) generally because of osaekomi-waza, shime-waza or kansetsu-waza.

c) When an athlete loses consciousness due to osaekomi-waza, shime-waza or kansetsu-waza.

Should one athlete be penalised with hansoku-make, the other athlete shall immediately be declared the winner with a score equivalent to ippon.

Special situations

a) Simultaneous techniques - when both athletes fall to the tatami after what appears to be simultaneous attacks and the referees cannot decide which technique dominated there should be no score awarded.

b) In the case where both athletes score simultaneous ippon, waza-ari and yuko the referee will act as regulated in article 13 paragraph 4.b.

Article 15 Waza-ari and Yuko

WAZA ARI

Scoring for actions that, without stopping, are a continuation of techniques. If there is a stop in the action, there is no score.

Evaluation of the points in tachi-waza. The referee shall announce waza-ari (a near ippon) when in his opinion the applied technique corresponds to the following criteria:

- Landing more than 90 degrees of the shoulder axis but not on the back.
- A score will be given for a whole side of the body landing even when the elbow is out. Only the shoulder position must be considered. Everything that is out of this range will be yuko or no score.
- When the four ippon criteria (speed, force, on the back and skilfully controlled until the end of the landing) are not fully achieved.



Picture 15.1

Waza-ari evaluation in ne-waza

When an athlete holds the other athlete with osaekomi-waza, after “Osaekomi!” for 10 seconds or more, but less than 20 seconds (10-19 seconds).

YUKO

Yuko in tachi-waza is defined as:

- Side landing (90 degrees) or more to the front landing.
- Landing on upper back
- Landing on the side on the shoulder axis and one elbow or one hand.
- Landing on both buttocks, close to 90 degrees to the front, 90 degrees or more to the rear (yuko and no shido).
- Landing on one buttock, with or without touching with elbow-elbows and/or arm-arms the mat.
- Landing on the neck.

Yuko will NOT be awarded if the front of the stomach, the front of both hips, or both knees touch the mat before a side landing (90° or more toward the front).

Yuko evaluation in ne-waza

When an athlete holds the other athlete with osaekomi-waza, after “Osaekomi!” is announced for 5 seconds or more, but less than 10 seconds (5-9 seconds).

Yuko scores are counted (1, 2, 3, etc.) but they do not add up to waza-ari.

Article 17 Osaekomi-waza

The referee shall announce “Osaekomi!” for applied Kodokan classified osaekomi-waza techniques or variants when the athlete being held:

- Is controlled from the side, rear or on top by his opponent and
- Has his full back or complete upper back (scapular region) in contact with the tatami.

The athlete applying the osaekomi-waza or variants must not have his body or his leg(s) controlled by his opponent's legs either from above or from below the leg.

In the following situations (pictures 17.1-17.2) after that the referee has announced “Osaekomi!” he shall announce “Toketa!”



Pictures 17.1-17.2

The athlete applying the osaekomi-waza must have his body on and over the opponent's body covering it and holding the opponent down underneath his body.

He must apply pressure onto the opponent's front upper body with his front upper body in either the kesa, the shiho or ura position, i.e., similar to the techniques kesa-kami-shiho-ura-gatame and sankaku situations.

Should an athlete who is controlling his opponent with an osaekomi-waza, change without losing control, into another osaekomi-waza, the “Osaekomi!” time will continue until the announcement of ippon (or equivalence), “Toketa!” or “Mate!”.

When osaekomi-waza is being applied and TORI commits an infringement meriting a penalty (shido) the referee shall announce “Mate!”, return the athletes to their standing positions and:

- If the “Osaekomi!” time is less than 5 seconds, award the penalty then recommence the contest by announcing “Hajime!”;
- If the “Osaekomi!” time is 5 seconds or more, but less than 10 seconds, award the penalty and the score (yuko);
- If the “Osaekomi!” time is 10 seconds or more, but less than 20 seconds, award the penalty and the score (waza-ari);

then recommence the contest by announcing “Hajime!”.

When “Osaekomi!” is being applied and uke commits an infringement meriting a penalty, the referee shall award the penalty by directly pointing at the uke WITHOUT interrupting the contest with “Sono-mama!”.

When the situation permits and in order not to interrupt the positive action of tori, the referee will award directly the penalty pointing uke without interrupting the contest with “Sono-mama!”.

However, should the penalty to be awarded be hansoku-make for tori or uke, the referee shall, after announcing “Sono-mama!”, consult with the IJF Referee Director(s) and/or the IJF Referee Supervisor(s), announce “Mate!” to return the athletes to their starting positions, then award hansoku-make and end the contest by announcing “Sore-made!”.

If an “Osaekomi!” exists, but the referee has not announced “Osaekomi!”, the IJF Referee Director(s) and/or the IJF Referee Supervisor(s) must inform the referee, who shall announce “Osaekomi!” immediately.

The IJF Referee Director(s) and/or the IJF Referee Supervisor(s), having consulted the CARE system, can quantify the exact time of the “Osaekomi!” and communicate it to the Referee for the relative decision.

The referee, after the announcement “Osaekomi!” must not announce “Toketa!” in the presence of situations in which, for example, the back of the athlete being held is no longer in contact with the tatami, (e.g., “bridging”), but the athlete applying the hold maintains the initial control anyway.

If uke escapes from osaekomi-waza outside the contest area in the proximity of the limit of the contest area and no more than two metres:

- The referee must call “Mate!” if there is NO immediate continuation from either tori or uke in applying osaekomi-waza, shime-waza or kansetsu-waza and, if the case, assign the relevant osaekomi-waza score.
- The referee must call “Toketa!” if there is an immediate continuation from either tori or uke in applying osaekomi-waza, shime-waza or kansetsu-waza, and, if the case, assign the relevant osaekomi score, leaving this last action to continue.
- If the osaekomi-waza action outside the contest area goes beyond the limit of the safety area the referee must call “Ippon! Sore-Made!”

These kinds of osaekomi-waza (pictures 17.3-17.4) are not valid and the referee must call “Mate!” if there is no progression in the action.



Pictures 17.3-17.4

These kinds of osaekomi-waza (pictures 17.5-17.7) are not valid and the referee must call “Mate!” immediately.



Pictures 17.5-17.7

It is never allowed to hold an osaekomi-waza just around the head/neck without control of at least one arm. Control in ne-waza using arms around the neck, without opponent's arm inside will be considered as “Mate!” Control in ne-waza using legs around the neck, without opponent's arm inside will be considered as “Mate!” and “Shido!”.

Article 18 Prohibited Acts and Penalties

The prohibited acts are divided into infringements that receive the penalty of:

- Shido – two (2) shido can be awarded and the third will be hansoku-make. The athlete is disqualified and CAN continue in the competition, if applicable.
- Hansoku-make - the athlete is disqualified and CAN continue in the competition, if applicable.
- Hansoku-make - the athlete is disqualified and CANNOT continue in the competition.

A contest cannot be decided by single or accumulated shido, until hansoku-make is reached.

Referees are authorised to award penalties according to the “intention” or situation and in the best interest of the sport.

Should the referee decide to penalise the athlete(s), (except in the case of “Sono-mama!” in ne-waza) he shall temporarily stop the contest by announcing “Mate!”, should return the athletes to their starting positions (Article 11) and announce the penalty while pointing to the athlete(s) who committed the prohibited act.

Athletes are NOT allowed to intentionally touch the referee in a negative way. The IJF Ad Hoc Commission will review the situation and decide the outcome.

Article 18.1 Shido (Slight Infringements Group)

During the contest an athlete can receive a shido for a lack of combativity, an illegal move or action that is not considered dangerous, untidy attire or hair.

Two shido will be given as warnings and the third will be hansoku-make, the athlete is disqualified and can continue in the competition, if applicable.

Shido do not give a score to the other athlete, only technical scores can give points on the scoreboard.

When both athletes infringe the rules at the same time, each should be awarded a penalty according to the seriousness of the infringement.

When both athletes have been given two (2) shido and subsequently each receives a further penalty, they should both be given hansoku-make.

Shido infringements can be evaluated as hansoku-make if done in an obvious anti-sporting manner that is not fair play (e.g., if one athlete stamps on the foot of his opponent to throw him more than once, or just to block like crossing fingers to avoid the grip or uke, in an "Osaekomi!" situation, puts his hand forcefully on the face of tori to escape).

A penalty in ne-waza should be applied in the same manner as in Article 17 "Osaekomi!".

Score and penalties

- a) If an athlete (blue) commits a slight infringement and his opponent (white) throws him for ippon, white will be given ippon and the contest ended.
- b) If an athlete (blue) commits a slight infringement and his opponent (white with one waza-ari) throws him for waza-ari, white will be given waza-ari-awasete-ippon and the contest ended.
- c) If an athlete (blue) commits a slight infringement and his opponent (white with NO waza-ari) throws him for waza-ari, white will be given waza-ari and blue will be penalised with shido.
- d) If an athlete (blue) commits a slight infringement and his opponent (white) throws him for yuko, white will be given yuko and blue will be penalised with shido.

Continuation in ne-waza

If an athlete (blue) commits a slight infringement and throws his opponent (white) the referee will allow the ne-waza until WHITE has the advantage. The referee must announce "Mate!" to give the penalty to blue in the moment that blue takes the advantage in ne-waza.

Whenever a referee awards a penalty, he should demonstrate with a gesture the reason for the penalty.

A penalty can be awarded also after the announcement of "Sore-made!" for any prohibited act done during the time allotted for the contest or, in some exceptional situations, for serious acts done after the signal to end the contest. In this case the referee will apply the penalty in accordance with the IJF Head Referee Director(s) and/or IJF Referee Supervisor(s).

Article 19 Default and Withdrawal

The decision of fusen-gachi (win by default) shall be given to any athlete whose opponent does not appear for his contest according to the 30 seconds rule.

Forfeit of a contest: If one athlete is ready on time and the opponent is missing an IJF Sport Director (or nominated person) will ask the speaker to announce, the last call for the missing athlete.

The referee will then invite the prepared athlete to wait at the edge of the competition area. The scoreboard will start to count down 30 seconds.

If at the end of 30 seconds the opponent is still not present at the tatami, the referee will invite the athlete to enter the competition area and will be declared the winner by fusen-gachi.

The referee must be sure before awarding fusen-gachi that they have received the authority to do so by the IJF Sport Director or nominated person.

The IJF Ad Hoc Commission can decide if an athlete who lost a contest by fusen-gachi may participate in the repechage.

The decision of kiken-gachi shall be given to any athlete whose opponent withdraws from the competition for any reason, during the contest.

Any athlete not willing to comply with the requirements of hygiene, hair and head cover regulation (see E1.3 Hygiene) shall be refused the right to compete and the opponent shall win the contest by fusen-gachi, if the contest has not yet started, or by kiken-gachi, if the contest has already started.

If an athlete loses a contact lens during the contest and cannot immediately recover it, and if he then informs the referee that he cannot continue competing without the contact lens, the referee shall give the victory to his opponent by kiken-gachi.

Article 20 Injury, Illness or Accident

In this article the person in the role of the doctor is defined in Appendix E.

The decision of the contest where one athlete is unable to continue because of injury, illness or accident during the contest shall be given by the referee following the clauses below:

a) Injury

1. Where the cause of the injury is attributed to the injured athlete, he shall lose the contest.
2. Where it is impossible to determine which of the athletes was the cause of the injury, the athlete unable to continue shall lose the contest.
3. If there is an injury caused by athletes from another contest on a nearby tatami, the injured athlete has the right to ask the referee to see the doctor.

Treatment can be given if needed and the athlete can continue the contest if able.

F1.2 Athlete Scoreboards

The scoreboards must be placed in such a way that they are visible to the athletes, coaches, referee, the IJF Head Referee Director(s) and the IJF Referee Supervisor(s). They can be stand-alone TV screens or integrated in the LED.

The scoreboards must show:

- The name of the athletes.
- Which athlete is wearing the white judogi and which is wearing the blue judogi.
- The three-letter country code.
- The country flag.
- Weight category.
- The time.
- Scores and penalties.
- Event phase (Rof64, Rof32, Rof16, QF, SF, F etc.) including golden score.

